County of San Diego, Health and Human Services Agency (HHSA) CalWORKs/CalFresh/Medi-Cal/General Relief/Cash Assistance Program for Immigrants/County Medical Services Program Guide Special Notice

Earned Income Tax Credit Outreach	Number	Page
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Effective Date:
March 1, 2026

Background:
San Diego County's Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC) campaign provides outreach which is intended to provide customers with information to access potentially eligible tax credits, free tax preparation, and other filing services and resources. EITC payments and credits may have impact to Self-Sufficiency Services (SSS) programs such as California Work Opportunity and Responsibility for Kids (CalWORKs), CalFresh, Medi-Cal, General Relief (GR), Cash Assistance Program for Immigrants (CAPI) and County Medical Services (CMS).

Purpose:
To provide guidance on treatment of EITC payments and credits for SSS programs and outreach resources available for eligibility staff to provide to customers who are potentially eligible to tax credits, free tax preparation, and other filing services and resources.

Policy:
Treatment of Income from EITC
EITC payments are exempt for CalWORKs, CalFresh, CAPI, Medi-Cal and CMS.

For General Relief, EITC payments are counted as unearned income in the month received. If a customer received GR during 2025, and the customer receives the EITC, review the case for potential unreported earnings since EITC is for earned income.

EITC related payments and credits that customers may receive are EITC, CalEITC, Foster Youth Tax Credit (FYTC), Expanded Young Child Tax Credit (EYCTC).

Treatment of Property from EITC payments
The table below outlines the treatment of Property for payments received from EITC.

Program	Treatment of Property
CalWORKs and CalFresh	Exempt resources for 12 months, starting with the month that the payment is received.
Medi-Cal	EITC payments are exempt as property in the month following the month of receipt.
General Relief	Refund retained by the customer in the month following receipt is considered personal property.
CAPI	EITC payments are exempt as property in the month following the month of receipt.
CMS	Any portion of the refund retained by the beneficiary in the month following receipt is considered exempt personal property.

Procedure:

FRCs and ES Staff

If customers report EITC payments or credits, treat the income and property as listed in this notice. Distribute the EITC postcards to customers at all contacts and encourage them to contact 2-1-1 to receive free assistance with filing their taxes and claim available tax credits. If additional postcards are needed, they can be ordered through XEROX printing services.

References:

All County Information Notice (ACIN) No. I-01-26

Resources:

CalWORKs Program Guide (CPG) 44-100.C and 44-100.H2
CalFresh Program Guide (CFPG) 63-203 and 63-204.
Medi-Cal Program Guide (MPG) 09.06.01,10.02.01 and Desk Aid 56 MAGI Eligibility Groups and Aid Codes
General Relief Program Guide (GRPG) 90-400.5F
CAPI Program Guide (CAPI) PG 99-103.2B and 99-104.4B
CMS Program Guide (CMSPG) 06.01.02A and 06.04.03H

Sunset Date:

This policy will be reviewed for continuance by March 31, 2027.

Approval for Release:



Alberto Banuelos, Ph.D., Interim Director
Self-Sufficiency Services

Appendix A

FILE YOUR TAXES FOR *FREE!*

You may qualify for FREE tax filing assistance with an expert tax preparer.

Receive free tax filing assistance online or at a VITA (Volunteer Income Tax Assistance) site!

You may qualify for federal tax credits such as the Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC) and Child Tax Credit (CTC) and state credits such as the California EITC (CalEITC) and Young Child Tax Credit (YCTC) that can put money back in your pocket. Our trusted tax preparers will see if you qualify for other available tax credits to maximize your refund or reduce the amount you owe. Let us help you get the money you deserve!

Who Is Eligible?

Individuals/families, including Individual Taxpayer Identification Number (ITIN) filers, earning:

- **$1- $70,000 per year** can get free tax assistance and may qualify to claim federal tax credits
- **$1- $32,900 per year** may qualify for additional state tax credits

What You'll Need

- Photo ID
- Social Security Card or ITIN for yourself and any dependent(s)
- Income documents including any W2s or 1099s
- Bank account information for direct deposit
- School tuition or student loan interest statements
- Dates of health coverage for yourself and any dependent(s)

How To File

- **Call 2-1-1** or go to **myfreetaxes.org** to see if you qualify and to make an appointment.
- Tax preparation services are available in multiple languages.
- Qualifying individuals can receive in-person tax assistance or file online for free by going to myfreetaxes.org.

Call 2-1-1 or visit myfreetaxes.org to learn more!

SAN DIEGO COUNTY EITC Earned Income Tax Credit COALITION

This program is brought to you by the San Diego County EITC Coalition and the following partners:

CSD · County of San Diego · Live Well San Diego · United Way of San Diego County · 2-1-1 San Diego · IRS · Cal EITC 4 me

¡PRESENTE SU DECLARACIÓN DE IMPUESTOS DE FORMA *GRATUITA!*

Es posible que reúna los requisitos para recibir asistencia GRATUITA para presentar su declaración de impuestos con un experto en preparar presentaciones de impuestos.

¡Reciba asistencia gratuita para la presentación de la declaración de impuestos en línea o en un sitio del programa de Asistencia Voluntaria para la Presentación del Impuesto sobre la Renta (Volunteer Income Tax Assistance, VITA)!

Puede calificar para créditos tributarios federales, como el Crédito del Impuesto sobre la Renta del Trabajo (Earned Income Tax Credit, EITC) y el Crédito Tributario por Hijos (Child Tax Credit, CTC), y créditos estatales, como el EITC de California (CalEITC) y el Crédito Tributario por Hijos Menores (Young Child Tax Credit, YCTC), que pueden devolverle dinero a su bolsillo. Nuestros preparadores de impuestos de confianza verán si usted califica para otros créditos tributarios disponibles para maximizar su reembolso o reducir el monto que adeuda. ¡Permítanos ayudarle a obtener el dinero que se merece!

¿Quién cumple con los requisitos?

Personas/familias, incluidos los declarantes con Número de Identificación Personal de Contribuyente (Individual Taxpayer Identification Number, ITIN), que ganan:

- **De $1 a $70,000 por año;** pueden obtener asistencia tributaria gratuita y pueden calificar para reclamar créditos tributarios federales
- **De $1 a $32,900 por año;** pueden calificar para créditos tributarios estatales adicionales

Lo que necesitará

- Identificación con fotografía
- Tarjeta de Seguro Social o ITIN para usted y cualquier dependiente
- Documentos de sus ganancias, incluidos los formularios W2 o 1099
- Información de la cuenta bancaria para depósito directo
- Estados contables de la matrícula escolar o de intereses de préstamos estudiantiles
- Fechas de cobertura médica para usted y cualquier dependiente

Cómo presentar una solicitud

- **Llame al 2-1-1** o visite **myfreetaxes.org** para comprobar si reúne los requisitos y programar una cita.
- Los servicios de preparación de impuestos están disponibles en varios idiomas.
- Las personas que reúnan los requisitos pueden recibir asistencia tributaria en persona o presentar su solicitud en línea de forma gratuita en myfreetaxes.org.

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Appendix B

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Tax Year 2025 CalEITC Income Limits

Number of Qualifying Children	State EITC Income Limits	State EITC Maximum Credits
None	$32,900	$302
1	$32,900	$2,016
2	$32,900	$3,339
3 or more	$32,900	$3,756

Tax Year 2025 Federal EITC Income Limits

Number of Qualifying Children	Single, Head of Household or Widowed	Married Filing Jointly	Federal EITC Maximum Credits (Up To)
None	$19,104	$26,214	$649
1	$50,434	$57,554	$4,328
2	$57,310	$64,430	$7,152
3 or more	$61,555	$68,675	$8,046

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Limites de Ingresos-2025 CalEITC:

Numero de Niños que Califican	Limites de Ingresos para el EITC Estatal	Creditos Maximos para el EITC Estatal
0	$32,900	$302
1	$32,900	$2,016
2	$32,900	$3,339
3 o mas	$32,900	$3,756

Limites de Ingresos federales del EITC:

Numero de Niños que Califican	Soltero, Jefe de Familia o Viudo	Casado y Declara en Conjunto	Creditos Maximos para el EITC Federal
0	$19,104	$26,214	$649
1	$50,434	$57,554	$4,328
2	$57,310	$64,430	$7,152
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